

Sketching & Drawing Workshop

Reference Guide — Foundations of Observation, Proportion, Perspective & Shading. Issued by KL SAC (Student Activity Center) as part of the SAMAM Activity Management Program.

About This Workshop

This workshop introduces students to the foundations of drawing by developing observation, proportion, perspective, and shading techniques. Beginners are welcome — no prior experience is required. By the end of the workshop, you should be able to construct a simple still-life or figure sketch with correct proportions, basic one-point perspective, and believable light-and-shadow rendering.

1. Observation — Learning to See

Good drawing starts with good looking. Instead of drawing what you think an object looks like, train yourself to draw what is actually in front of you.

- Squint at your subject to simplify it into large shapes and value blocks.
- Compare angles and negative space (the empty space around objects) rather than edges alone.
- Sketch loosely first — avoid committing to firm lines until the overall composition feels right.

2. Proportion

Proportion is the relationship in size between different parts of a subject. Two techniques used throughout the workshop:

- **Unit measuring:** pick one recognizable part of the subject as a "unit" and measure the rest of the drawing against it (e.g. "the head is one unit; the body is seven units tall").
- **Sighting with a pencil:** hold your pencil at arm's length to compare relative lengths and angles between reference points.

3. Perspective

Perspective creates the illusion of depth on a flat page.

- **One-point perspective:** all receding lines converge to a single vanishing point on the horizon — useful for roads, hallways, and objects viewed head-on.
- **Two-point perspective:** uses two vanishing points on the horizon line, ideal for drawing objects at an angle, such as buildings viewed from a corner.
- Keep a consistent horizon line (eye level) for every object placed in the same scene.

4. Shading & Light

Shading gives a flat sketch volume and form by describing how light falls across it.

- Identify a single light source and keep it consistent across the whole drawing.
- Map five tonal zones: highlight, light, core shadow, reflected light, and cast shadow.
- Use hatching, cross-hatching, or blending (with a tissue or blending stump) to build up tone gradually — work light to dark.

Materials Checklist

Item	Purpose
Graphite pencils (2H, HB, 2B, 6B)	Range from light construction lines to deep shadow
A4 / A3 sketchbook or drawing sheets	Practice surface
Kneaded eraser	Lift graphite without smudging; can shape highlights
Blending stump or tissue	Smooth transitions between tonal zones
Ruler (optional)	Checking perspective construction lines

Assignment Reminder

Registered students must submit a portfolio of **3 original observational sketches** demonstrating proportion, perspective, and shading (see the Assignments tab on the activity page). Accepted formats: PDF, JPG, or PNG. Submissions are uploaded directly from your student dashboard.